

FROZEN FOOD RETAIL

Setup & Deployment

Cold-chain schema, migrations, feature flags and the minimal configuration needed to put a Frozen Foods Retailer store live.

What the cold chain adds

Frozen food retail uses the cold-chain half of the Butchery & Frozen module: freezer locations, temperature logs and per-item storage rules. It shares the same migrations and sidebar entry as the butchery workflow, but the carcass screens are not needed.



Tables used

db_freezer_locations and db_temperature_logs. Migration 016 also creates the carcass tables, which stay unused unless meat_butchery_workflow is enabled.



Item fields

storage_temp_min, storage_temp_max, thaw_time_hours, use_within_hours_after_thaw, frozen_shelf_life_days on db_items.



Feature flag

frozen_food_cold_chain requires warehouse_module() and must be in the store feature list. The frozen_foods_retailer preset enables it automatically.



Mobile shell

/mobile/butchery_coldchain is a dedicated mobile view — custom selects, bottom nav, alerts and MartPoint Assist chat.

i Preset applied: Choosing Frozen Foods Retailer sets theme market_fresh, dashboard frozen_foods, and relabels items as Product / Pack.

Run the migrations

The module uses the existing CodeIgniter migration system. Run from the project root to apply the schema.

```
php index.php migrations
```

Expected output:

Migrations complete. Current version: 24



Migration 015

Adds the storage, thaw and shelf-life columns to `db_items`. Safe to re-run because it checks for existing columns.



Migration 016

Creates `db_freezer_locations` and `db_temperature_logs` alongside the carcass tables. Each `CREATE TABLE` is guarded by `table_exists`.

Verify after migrating

```
SHOW COLUMNS FROM db_items LIKE 'storage_temp_min';  
SHOW TABLES LIKE 'db_freezer_locations';  
SHOW TABLES LIKE 'db_temperature_logs';
```

Enable the module per store

The feature must be enabled per store. Use the Business Profile page for new stores or SQL for existing deployments.

1

Business Profile (recommended)

Go to **Settings** → **Business Profile**. Choose Frozen Foods Retailer. In the Feature Flags tab, enable Branch / Stock Transfer (warehouse), Frozen Food Cold Chain, Batch Tracking, Expiry Tracking and Multi-Unit Selling. Save and refresh.

2

Force via SQL

If the UI is not reachable, run this for the target store:

```
UPDATE db_store
SET feature_flags_json = JSON_SET(
  COALESCE(feature_flags_json, '{}'),
  '$.warehouse', true,
  '$.frozen_food_cold_chain', true,
  '$.batch_tracking', true,
  '$.expiry_tracking', true,
  '$.multi_unit_selling', true
)
WHERE id = {store_id};
```

Note: Replace {store_id}. If MySQL does not support JSON_SET, set the raw JSON string directly. If db_store_industry_settings exists, apply the same update to its row — it is checked first. meat_butchery_workflow is not required for cold-chain screens — see next page.

URLs and feature gating

Cold-chain screens live under the shared Butchery controller. The sidebar shows **Butchery & Frozen** when either `meat_butchery_workflow` or `frozen_food_cold_chain` is enabled.



Desktop routes

- > `/butchery`
- > `/butchery/freezers`
- > `/butchery/temperature`
- > `/butchery/receive` — butchery only
- > `/butchery/cut/{id}` — butchery only
- > `/butchery/shares` — butchery only



Mobile routes

- > `/mobile/` — freezers +
`butchery_coldchain` temperature
- > `/mobile/butchery` — butchery only
- > `/mobile/` — butchery
`butchery_form` only
- > `/mobile/` — butchery
`butchery_cut/{id}` only
- > `/mobile/` — butchery
`butchery_shares` only

⚠ Gating: Cold-chain screens (freezers, temperature) accept either flag, so a frozen-only store gets full desktop access with just `frozen_food_cold_chain`. The carcass routes (receive, cut, shares) stay gated by `meat_butchery_workflow`. For frozen-only stores `/butchery` renders a Cold Chain dashboard showing only the Freezers and Temperature cards. Mobile `butchery_coldchain` accepts either flag and appears as a **Cold Chain** tile under More → Inventory.

Item form, alerts & stock

When `frozen_food_cold_chain` (or `meat_butchery_workflow`) is on, the item add/edit form shows a **Butchery & Frozen** card. It is hidden for service, digital, course and membership product types.

Item fields saved by `Items_model::save_record()`

- ✓ `storage_temp_min` / `storage_temp_max` ✓ `frozen_shelf_life_days`
- ✓ `thaw_time_hours` ✓ `is_carcass` , `carcass_template_id` , `portion_o`
- ✓ `use_within_hours_after_thaw`

Temperature log statuses

Each reading on `db_temperature_logs` is saved with a status:

- ✓ `normal` — reading inside the freezer's min/max range.
- ✓ `warning` — reading below `temp_min` or above `temp_max` .
- ✓ `alert_sent` flag is stored per row for notification workflows.

Inventory features that work alongside

- ✓ `batch_tracking` + `expiry_tracking` — batch and expiry per carton; Stock Rotation screen under Operations.
- ✓ `multi_unit_inventory` + `multi_unit_selling` — sell the same item by carton, pack or kilo.
- ✓ `pos_retail_button` / `pos_wholesale_button` — quick price switching at the POS.

Mobile & deployment

The cold-chain mobile view follows the MartPoint mobile rules and is gated by the same flags as the desktop module.



Mobile shell & isolation

/mobile/butchery_coldchain uses mobile/ views, not mp_layout — store name in the title, custom mp-select, bottom nav, alert and chat partials. The module only appears for stores with the right profile and flags; other verticals are unaffected.

Deployment checklist

- ✓ PHP 7.4 configured on the server.
- ✓ Migrations run to version 24 .
- ✓ warehouse flag enabled.
- ✓ frozen_food_cold_chain enabled for desktop and mobile.
- ✓ Butchery & Frozen appears in sidebar and mobile More.
- ✓ Create a freezer; log in-range and out-of-range readings.
- ✓ Verify the Butchery & Frozen card on the item form.
- ✓ Test a weighted POS sale and an online checkout.